

ADVENTURE FOR THE FIFTH EDITION (2024) · WARCRAFT SETTING

THE MINE OF THE ABSENT FOREMAN

an evening of candles, kobolds and accounts that don't add up

ONE SESSION · THREE TO FIVE 1ST-LEVEL CHARACTERS

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Introduction

> *"Three days without a foreman and the mine is still standing. That's what worries me most."*
> — Hesperia Callaver

Premise and comic principle

A D&D adventure set in *Warcraft* for 3–5 1st-level characters, played in a single session of three or four hours. The characters begin as newcomers to *Goldshire* and finish at 2nd level, with a name the inn keeps repeating.

The *Copperseam*, a small mine south of the village, has been idle for three days. Its foreman, *Odo Cardoso*, has vanished, and the miners swear the kobolds took him. It isn't entirely a lie: the kobolds do have him. But they haven't kidnapped him. They've crowned him.

The comedy runs on misunderstanding. If *The Fall of Quel'Thalas* was a tragedy in which everything done right ended badly, this is its reverse: everything seems to go wrong and ends well. The audience needs no prior knowledge; the fun lies in finding out who is who.

- **Misunderstanding.** Everyone believes the kobolds hold the foreman prisoner; in fact they revere him as "the Great Candle."
- **Mask.** The kindly bookkeeper who offers to help is the one who sawed through the props.
- **Recognition.** In the kobold shrine, the foreman tells what he saw, and the mine changes culprits.
- **Restoration.** Order returns to Goldshire, with one small change: a kobold crew under contract.

A katabasis of initiation. The structure is that of the descent: one goes down into the dark, meets a strange king, and comes back with something not known before. For a group playing for the first time, the mine is the threshold: they go in as strangers and come out as neighbours.

Plots and table tools

Visible plot. Find the foreman and give the mine back to Mistress *Callaver*.

Hidden plot. *Wendel Scantcoin*, the mine's bookkeeper, sells the copper by night to the *Defias Brotherhood*. Odo found out; Wendel had the props sawed through to bury him along with the secret. Odo escaped downward, and down below were the kobolds.

The bookkeeper's clues. There are three, spread across Scenes 1 to 4: the ledger, the night carts and the sawed prop. The group need not gather them all; each one they hold eases the negotiation in Scene 4 and grants an edge in Scene 5.

Kobold Favour. A tracker from 0 to 5 that starts at 1. It rises when the characters respect the candles, share food or treat *Wick* kindly; it drops when they snuff candles, kill fleeing kobolds or mock the Great Candle. It decides the shrine's attitude and whether the kobolds help in the finale.

Collapse Clock. Six segments, used only in Scene 5. It advances one per round. The characters can slow it, never stop it: the gallery is going to fall; the question is who is under it.

For first-time tables

Each scene teaches one rule and lets the table practise it before moving on. A first-time Game Master can follow this order and won't need to explain everything up front.

Scene 1: ability checks and proficiency. **Scene 2:** initiative, attacks and damage. **Scene 3:** group checks and saving throws. **Scene 4:** social interaction: Persuasion, Deception, Insight. **Scene 5:** everything at once, against a clock.

Every scene allows three ways out: fight, scheme or talk. None of them is the right one.

Soft fall. A character who drops to 0 Hit Points before Scene 5 doesn't die: they wake up tied with candlewick in the shrine, at 1 Hit Point and wearing a paper crown. Humiliating, not lethal.

Suggested running time

Scene	Content	Time
1	Goldshire: the job	30 min
2	The mine mouth	30 min
3	The upper galleries	50 min
4	The shrine of the Great Candle	40 min
5	The last prop	50 min
—	Epilogue and advancing to 2nd level	10 min

Lore moment

Stormwind has been rebuilt. The stonemasons who raised it and were never paid have taken to the hills wearing red kerchiefs: they are the *Defias Brotherhood*, and they are starting to show up in *Elwynn*. Meanwhile, kobolds hold the forest's mines, armed with picks and obsessed with their candles. The adventure can be played at any point in that period.

Setting names

This edition uses the names from the English version of *World of Warcraft*. The Spanish edition of the adventure uses the Spanish localisation; the table helps when playing with both.

In this adventure	Spanish edition
Elwynn Forest	Bosque de Elwynn
Goldshire	Villadorada
Stormwind	Ventormenta
Westfall	Páramos de Poniente
Defias Brotherhood	Hermandad Defias
Lion's Pride Inn	Posada del Orgullo de León
Copperseam Mine (invented)	Mina de la Veta Cobriza
Kobold	Kóbold

Game Master's tracking sheet

The bookkeeper's clues

- ☐ 1. The ledger *(Sc. 1)*
- ☐ 2. The night carts *(Sc. 2)*
- ☐ 3. The sawed prop *(Sc. 3)*

Kobold Favour *(starts at 1)*

0 · **1** · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5

+1 leave or light a candle · share food · treat Wick kindly · triumphant entrance · win Soot over · deal with Scratch

−1 snuff or take candles · kill fleeing kobolds · crash into the altar · mock the Great Candle

Collapse Clock *(Sc. 5)*

1 · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5 · 6

Cross out one candle per round. At 3: dust falls. At 6: the gallery caves in.

Dramatis personae

> *"Nobody kidnapped anybody. I hid. That's different."*
> — Odo Cardoso, the Great Candle

Each entry includes a description to read aloud the first time the character appears, and notes for the Game Master. All named characters are invented.

Odo Cardoso, the absent foreman

First appearance: Scene 4, in the shrine.

> He sits on a stack of empty blasting-powder crates as if they were a throne, and on his head he wears a crown made of some twenty lit candles. He has a broom of a moustache, a face black with soot and a sackcloth blanket over his shoulders that someone has decorated with copper tokens. When he sees you, he doesn't get up. He sighs, like a man watching the bill arrive.

Notes. Fifty-odd, grumpy, honest and tired. He discovered Wendel's double books, survived the cave-in prepared for him and went down into kobold territory. He taught them to make candles that don't drip, and they proclaimed him king. He doesn't want to leave: up there nobody will believe him, and Wendel will try again. He has to be convinced, not rescued.

Hesperia Callaver, owner of the mine

First appearance: Scene 1, at the inn.

> A slight woman in old mourning clothes, with a purse tied to her wrist by a cord. She counts her coins before she speaks, and she speaks the way she counts: unhurried and without mistakes. When she smiles, which is rarely, you can tell she used to smile more.

Notes. A widow, practical, with a dry sense of humour. She inherited the mine and has kept it open by sheer arithmetic. She trusts Odo, not kobold stories. She pays the reward and closes the adventure.

Wendel Scantcoin, the bookkeeper

First appearance: Scene 1, after the job is offered.

> Young and thin, with round spectacles that keep slipping down his nose and a ledger always under his arm. He apologises before interrupting, and apologises again afterwards. There is ink on his fingers and a red stain on his shirt cuff that might be sealing wax. Or might not.

Notes. The villain. Kind, obliging, cowardly. He sells the copper to the Defias Brotherhood and keeps two sets of books: one for Mistress Callaver and one for himself. He tries to persuade the group to wait for the Stormwind guard, and if he fails, he follows them at a distance. He flees as soon as he loses half his Hit Points.

Tilda Heath, miner

First appearance: Scene 1, at the inn.

> A broad-shouldered girl with her hair tucked under a kerchief and an unlit lantern she won't let go of even to eat. She speaks softly, and every couple of sentences she glances at the door, as if something might come through it.

Notes. The only miner who dares go back as far as the mine mouth, though no further. She believes in ghosts and is sure the mine is cursed. Her mule, *Stubborn*, plays a decisive part in the finale.

Scratch, chief of the kobolds

First appearance: Scene 4.

> He is taller than the other kobolds, which means he comes up to your waist. He wears a human miner's helmet far too big for him, with a candle so fat stuck on top that he has to walk with his head held very straight so it won't fall off. He speaks in a coughing voice, in broken Common, and every time he says "Great Candle" he points at the foreman with both hands.

Notes. Jealous of his authority and proud of his people. His rules are few and firm: you don't touch someone else's candle, you don't snuff a candle, the Great Candle doesn't leave. He can be bargained with if offered something better than what he loses.

Soot, the geomancer

First appearance: Scene 3.

> An old kobold with grey fur and chewed ears, covered in little stones sewn onto her clothes. When she moves her fingers, the gravel on the floor trembles, and a few pebbles stay floating around her like flies.

Notes. Guardian of the upper galleries. She distrusts humans more than Scratch does, and with better reason: she knows someone is sawing the props, and she thinks it was them.

Wick, the little kobold

First appearance: Scene 2, at the mine mouth.

> A small furry thing with a nose that never stops twitching, holding in both hands a candle so short it nearly burns his fingers. He looks at you, looks at the candle, looks at you again. And says, very seriously: "You no take candle."

Notes. The youngest lookout, and the worst. If treated kindly, he joins the group as a guide and appears in every scene. He is the tender counterpoint, like Taeren in *Quel'Thalas*, but here nobody is left behind. The table decides his fate: he may end up as an apprentice in the mine, the inn's mascot or the chronicler of the Great Candle.

Rufus Morral, of the Defias Brotherhood

First appearance: Scene 5.

> A big man, his hands covered in stonemason's scars, with a red kerchief knotted at his neck. He carries a mason's mallet on his shoulder the way one carries a tool, not a weapon. He never smiles.

Notes. A former Stormwind stonemason who was never paid. He doesn't hate the characters; he hates people who don't pay. If shown that Wendel has been cheating him too (the double ledger proves it), he may walk away from the fight.

Others

- ***Stubborn***, the mine mule. She won't move unless she wants to, and once she plants her hooves, nobody shifts her.
- ***Two Defias thugs***, who carry the powder and ask no questions.
- ***Kobold miners***, all named after things that burn: Spark, Ember, Match, Tinder.

Locations

> *"In this mine, whoever brings no candle brings fear."*
> — Goldshire saying

Descriptions to read aloud on arriving at each place. They are listed in order of appearance; the numbers refer to the map.

Goldshire at dusk (Scene 1)

The Stormwind road enters the village between tall oaks and meadows where sheep graze. There is a smithy that never stops ringing, a stone tower with a pointed roof and, in the centre, a large inn with a lion painted over the door. Inside it smells of stew and lukewarm ale. Nobody sits at one table at the back: it belongs to the miners, and today it is empty.

The road to the mine

The path leaves the village heading south, between ferns that reach your knees. Cart ruts are cut deep into the mud. Some are days old. Others are from last night.

The mine mouth (1)

The entrance to the Copperseam is a frame of old beams wedged into a hillside, with a crooked sign and an overturned water bucket. The rails come out of the darkness and vanish into the grass. Inside, far at the back, there is a small, flickering light. And then another. And another.

The upper galleries (2)

Low passages, the ceiling held up by oak props that creak as you pass. Everything is full of candles: on ledges, in hollows in the rock, stuck to the rails with their own wax. Nobody has put them out. Someone tends them.

The crossing of the props (3)

Four galleries meet in a chamber higher than the rest, held up by four props as thick as a man. One of them is split in half, and the ceiling above it sags like a belly.

The cart shaft (4)

The track slopes down into the darkness. Beside it waits a cart full of stones, held by a wooden wedge. From below rises a warm air that smells of wax and, very far away, someone is singing.

The shrine of the Great Candle (5)

A wide cavern where the rock gleams with copper. Hundreds of candles cover the floor, the walls and the ceiling, one on top of another, until they form a kind of beehive of light. In the centre, on an altar of crates, sits a man with a burning crown.

The new-seam gallery (6)

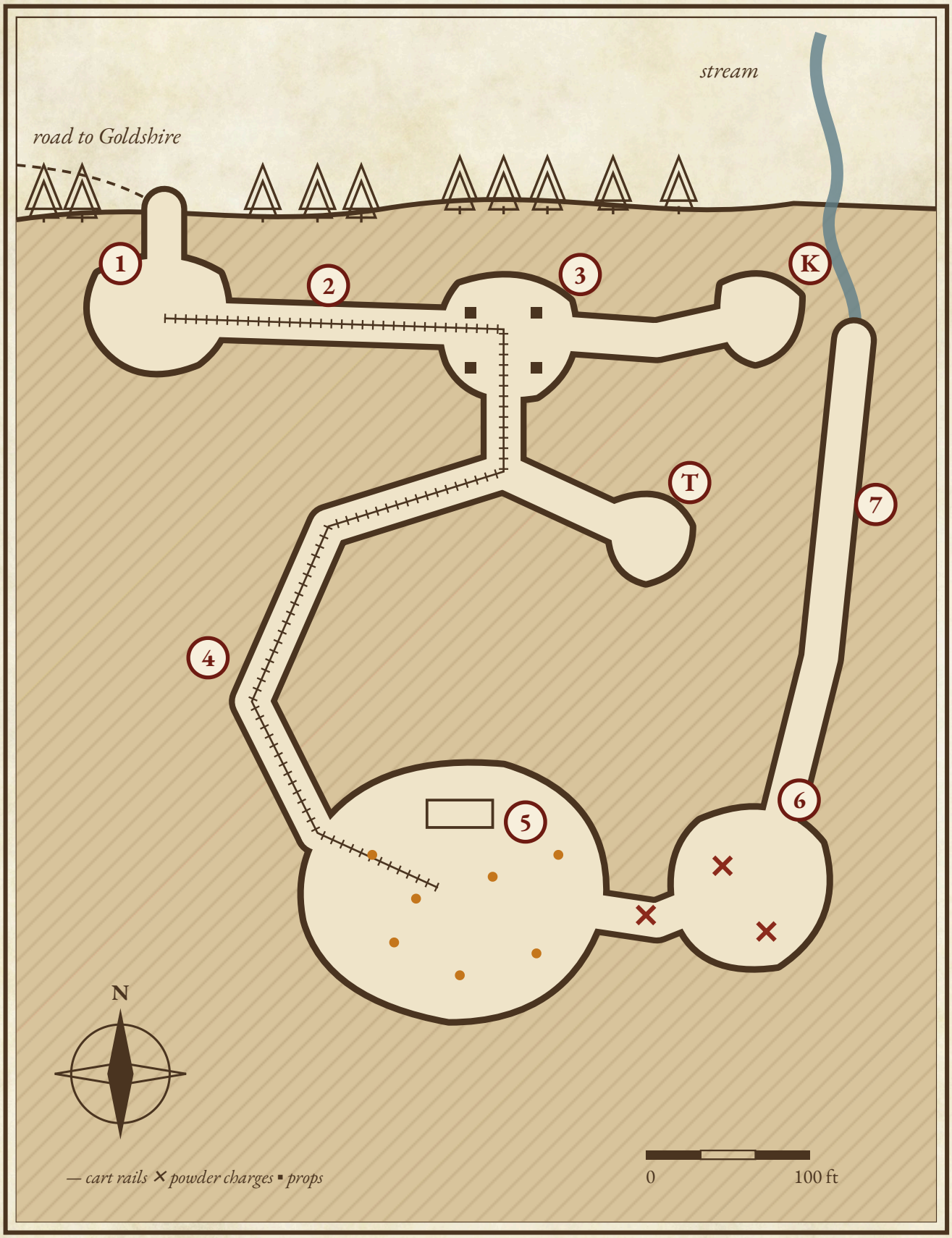
A freshly dug tunnel whose walls are red with pure copper, richer than anything you have seen in the mine. At the far end, the air moves. There is an exit that appears on no plan.

The smugglers' mouth (7)

A crack among roots beside the stream, covered with branches cut by an axe. From outside it looks like a burrow. From inside, you can hear wheels.

FOR THE GAME MASTER

Map of the Copperseam



1 Mine mouth · 2 Upper galleries · 3 Crossing of the props · 4 Cart shaft · 5 Shrine of the Great Candle · 6 New-seam gallery · 7 Smugglers' mouth · T Dead-end gallery with trap · K Kobold burrows.

Scene 1: The Job

> *"Kobolds? Odo has kicked out more kobolds than you'll see in your whole lives."*
> — Hesperia Callaver

The characters receive the job at the inn, meet the people who matter and, if they pay attention, find the first clue.

Rule of the scene
Ability checks. When the outcome is uncertain, roll 1d20 + modifier against a DC: 10 easy, 12 moderate, 15 hard.

1. **The inn** (read "Goldshire at dusk"). The characters may arrive together or meet here: the miners' empty table is a good excuse.
2. **Hesperia's job** (text below). She offers 10 gold pieces each for bringing back Odo, alive or with news, and 15 more if the mine works again.
3. **Rumours.** Each character who asks around the room rolls on the rumour table, or the table chooses.
4. **Wendel offers help.** As they leave, the bookkeeper catches up with them at the door (text below). He tries to get them to wait for the guard; if he fails, he wishes them luck with a strained smile. Insight DC 12: he really is nervous, and not for their sake.
5. **Tilda and Stubborn.** The miner agrees to guide them as far as the mine mouth, no further. The mule comes with her; there's no way around it.

Clue 1: the ledger. If someone asks to see the mine's accounts, Hesperia lends them the copy Wendel gives her. Investigation DC 12: output falls every month, but the use of candles, rope and powder rises. Someone is working very hard to get very little. On a 15 or higher, it is also clear that cart departures are always recorded by day, and Tilda swears she has heard them at night.

Close. Night falls. The group heads south with a lantern, a mule and the feeling that someone is watching them from the inn window.

Text: the job

Mistress Callaver counts six coins onto the table before she looks up.

"Odo Cardoso has been going down that mine for twenty-two years. He knows every prop by name. And three days ago he didn't come back up." She pushes the coins towards you. "My miners say the kobolds took him. My miners also say there's a ghost in the north gallery that steals sandwiches."

She snaps the purse shut.

"Bring me Odo. And if you can't bring me Odo, bring me the truth. I pay the same for both, because the truth costs too."

Text: the bookkeeper

"Excuse me! Excuse me, sorry to bother you." A young man in spectacles catches up with you at the door, out of breath, a book clutched to his chest. "I'm Wendel, the mistress's bookkeeper. I only wanted to say that... well, that there's no need for you to risk yourselves. I've written to the Stormwind guard. They'll be here in a week. Two at most."

He pushes his spectacles up with an ink-stained finger.

"If you wait, I'll pay for your room myself. Out of my own pocket." He smiles. "It's the least I can do."

Rumours at the inn

Each character who talks to the regulars rolls 1d6, or the Game Master chooses. The rumours marked false are not lies: they are what people believe.

1d6	Rumour	Truth
1	"Kobolds kidnap people to make candles for them."	Almost true, and in the foreman's case, literally true.
2	"There's a ghost in the north gallery that steals sandwiches."	It's Wick.
3	"Odo and the mistress argued about money last week."	False. They argued because Odo asked to check the accounts, and Wendel refused.
4	"There are carts heading for Westfall at night."	True. This is Clue 2 early: with it, the ruts in Scene 2 explain themselves.
5	"The bookkeeper has bought a new horse. And boots."	True. Insight DC 10: a bookkeeper's wage doesn't buy boots like those.
6	"The red-kerchief lot are hanging around the stream."	True. It's the Defias Brotherhood, by the smugglers' mouth.

If the table gets stuck

If the group shows no interest in the bookkeeper, no matter: Scene 4 reveals him anyway. Clues are an advantage, not a requirement. And if someone suspects Wendel from the start, perfect: let them watch him. Wendel will do nothing in the village; he will wait in the mine.

If the characters take Wendel's money

Nothing bad happens, at first. They sleep at the inn. At midnight, Tilda knocks on their door: she has seen Wendel leave the village heading south, with a shuttered lantern. The adventure starts the same way, but in a hurry, and Wendel is already in the mine when they arrive, which brings Scene 5 forward.

Tilda in the scene

She is a good source of atmosphere. She says she heard a long creak in the upper gallery on the day of the cave-in, "like a tree falling, but slowly." That the kobolds had never come up so far. And that the candles started appearing the same night Odo disappeared. "Someone lights them. All of them. Every night."

If a character encourages or protects her on the way, Tilda overcomes her fear at the end of Scene 5 and comes in to help with Stubborn.

Scene 2: The Mine Mouth

> *"You no take candle."*
> — Wick, kobold lookout

First contact with the kobolds. It may be a fight, a chase or a very clumsy conversation. The group discovers that the kobolds are guarding something, and that there are carts where there shouldn't be.

Rule of the scene
Initiative and combat. Everyone rolls Dexterity; the highest acts first. On their turn, each creature moves and takes one action. To attack, roll 1d20 + bonus against the target's AC.

1. **The road** (read "The road to the mine"). **Clue 2: the carts.** Survival DC 11: there are deep ruts from loaded carts that don't go towards the village but west, along the stream. They are from last night, two days after the "kidnapping."
2. **The mine mouth** (read "The mine mouth"). Tilda stops here. So does Stubborn.
3. **Minor encounter: the lookouts.** Three kobold miners guard the entrance, each with a candle. Wick is hiding behind a bucket. The kobolds don't attack unless someone touches their candles; if someone does, they shout their catchphrase and charge.
4. **Wick.** If the group neither kills nor scares him, he stays. With a gift (food, a candle, something shiny) or Persuasion DC 10, he offers himself as a guide.

Dealing with the lookouts

If the group...	What happens	Favour
Attacks first	Combat. The kobolds flee when one falls.	–1 if fleeing kobolds are killed
Snuffs or takes a candle	The kobolds attack with Advantage (see their stat block).	–1
Lights a candle of their own and leaves it	The lookouts calm down and watch curiously.	+1
Shares food	The kobolds snatch it from their hands and let them pass.	+1
Speaks Common slowly	Persuasion DC 12. Success: they let them pass in exchange for something.	—

Close. If the lookouts flee, they run inside shouting "Great Candle! Great Candle!" The group doesn't yet know it is a name.

Text: the lookouts

> Three short figures come out from behind the carts. They look like big rats standing upright, with snouts sniffing the air, clothes made of sacks and miners' picks in their hands. Each one wears a lit candle on its head, stuck to a helmet or a cap.
>
> They stop a few paces away. The one in the middle raises its pick, points at you and says, with great dignity:
>
> "You no pass. Candle of Great Candle. Candle no touch."
>
> Behind it, from an overturned bucket, a small nose peeks out. And an even smaller candle.

Text: Wick introduces himself

> The smallest kobold climbs out of the bucket, plants himself in front of you with the candle in both hands and looks you up and down.
>
> "You no take candle," he says, very seriously. And then, more quietly: "You have cheese?"

Scene 3: The Upper Galleries

> *"Humans cut woods! Humans want roof on head!"*
> — Soot, the geomancer

The exploration of the mine proper. The group discovers that the cave-in was no accident, faces the guardian of the galleries and goes down to the shrine in the noisiest way possible.

Rule of the scene
Group checks and saving throws. In a group check, if half or more succeed, the whole group succeeds. A saving throw is rolled to resist something that happens to you, not to do something.

1. **The upper galleries** (read the location). Wick, if he is with them, relights any snuffed candles and scolds anyone who brushes against them.
2. **The dead-end gallery (T).** A kobold trap: a rope strung with little bells and a bucket of gravel above the entrance. Perception DC 12 to spot it. If triggered: Dexterity saving throw DC 11 or 3 (1d6) Bludgeoning damage and a bucket on the head. Inside there is a sack of stolen cheese (the ghost's) and 1d6 kobold candles.
3. **The crossing of the props** (read the location). **Clue 3: the sawed prop.** Investigation DC 12, or any character with carpenter's or mason's tools automatically: the cut is clean and straight, made by a saw. Nobody gnawed it. Someone cut it on purpose.
4. **Main encounter: Soot.** The geomancer and four kobold miners defend the crossing (for three characters, only three kobolds). Soot believes humans sawed the prop, and she is right, though not these humans. If the group shows her the cut and explains who could have done it, Insight or Persuasion DC 13, she stops fighting and sends them "to talk to Great Candle." Favour +1.
5. **The runaway cart.** To get down to the shrine, the group must use the shaft track. If the group doesn't decide, Soot does: when the fight goes badly, she knocks out the wedge and the cart takes off with everyone nearby aboard (mechanics on the next page).

Close. The cart, with or without passengers, ends up in the shrine. The manner of arrival decides the first impression.

Text: Soot

> The stones on the floor start trembling before you see her. Then she appears: an old grey kobold wrapped in a cloak of pebbles that clatter as she walks. Half a dozen stones float around her, slowly turning.
>
> She points at the split prop with a crooked claw.
>
> "Humans cut woods! Humans want roof on head of Great Candle!" The stones stop in mid-air, aimed at you. "Soot no let. Soot never let."

Text: the cut

> Up close, the prop isn't broken. It's been cut. The wood bears the clean, repeated mark of saw teeth, drawn back and forth until only a hand's breadth of oak was left holding up the roof. In the sawdust on the floor, half trodden in, lies a scrap of red cloth.

The runaway cart

The shaft track runs down to the shrine in three stretches. Everyone riding the cart takes part: each stretch is a group check. Each character chooses one of the two checks the stretch offers and describes what they do.

Stretch	Place	Checks (DC 11)	If the group fails
1	The slope	Strength (Athletics) to brake with a pick or Dexterity (Acrobatics) to lean into the bend	The cart jumps a rail. Each passenger takes 2 (1d4) Bludgeoning damage.
2	The broken switch	Intelligence (Investigation) to see which rail continues or Strength to shove the lever	They take the wrong branch and plough through a burrow. Favour –1 and cheese everywhere.
3	The bat tunnel	Wisdom (Perception) to duck in time or a Constitution saving throw to take the blow	Every light goes out. They arrive in the dark, which is worse than arriving badly.

Help. A spell or a good idea grants Advantage to whoever has it or to a companion. Wick, if he is riding with the group, shrieks the right direction at stretch 2 (Advantage for everyone).

Arrival. At the end, count the stretches passed.

Stretches passed	Arrival at the shrine
3	Triumphant entrance. The cart brakes right in front of the altar. The kobolds applaud despite themselves. Favour +1 and Heroic Inspiration for whoever made the best roll.
2	A dignified arrival, with a little smoke.
1	The cart overturns. The kobolds laugh. So does the foreman, for the first time in three days.
0	The cart overturns onto the altar and snuffs out forty candles. Favour –1. The shrine greets them with picks raised.

If nobody wants to ride

The group can always walk down the track, slowly. It takes longer and isn't fun, but it works: a Dexterity (Stealth) group check DC 12 to go unseen. When they arrive, the kobolds have already been warned.

Text: the descent

> The wedge flies out. For a moment, nothing happens. Then the cart tips forward, the wheels screech and the darkness rushes at you. The air hits your face, warm and smelling of wax. The walls pass so close you can hear the candles go out as you go by, one after another, like applause.
>
> Ahead, an enormous light grows and grows. And someone shouts, in the voice of a tired man:
>
> "The brake! The lever on the left, by the blessed Light!"

Scene 4: The Shrine of the Great Candle

> *"Great Candle no go. Great Candle stay forever."*
> — Scratch, chief of the kobolds

The heart of the comedy. The group finds the foreman, who doesn't want to be rescued, a kobold king who won't let him go, and the truth about the cave-in. Here the misunderstanding comes undone.

Rule of the scene

Social interaction. Characters don't convince by rolling dice: they convince with arguments, and the dice say whether the argument lands. Persuasion to reason, Deception to lie, Insight to find out what the other is hiding.

1. **The shrine** (read the location and the descriptions of Odo and Scratch).
2. **The initial attitude** depends on Favour: 0–1 hostile (the kobolds surround the group, armed); 2–3 wary (they listen, from a distance); 4–5 friendly (Scratch offers them a piece of candle to eat, as a mark of honour).
3. **The foreman's confession** (text below). Odo tells what he saw. If the group has no clues at all, he tells it anyway, but he doesn't believe anyone in the village will take his word for it.
4. **The negotiation** (next page). Two must be convinced: Odo, to leave, and Scratch, to let him go.
5. **The tremor.** When the negotiation ends, well or badly, the mine shakes. It comes from the new-seam gallery. Odo turns pale: "Powder. They're blowing the new gallery."

If there is a fight. Scratch and four kobold miners. Odo shouts at them to stop from the first round; if a character stops attacking and agrees with him, the kobolds stop too. It isn't a fight the group has to win, but one they have to get out of.

Close. The group, Odo and perhaps the kobolds run towards the new-seam gallery.

Text: the foreman's confession

"Nobody kidnapped me. I hid. That's different." Odo takes off the crown carefully, without putting out a single candle, and sets it on the crates. "A month ago I started counting the carts. More were going out than the lad was writing down. A lot more. I told him, because I'm a fool, and he said he'd look into it."

He scratches his moustache.

"Three days later, the crossing came down on me. I got out through a crack, rolling, and landed down here. With a lamp." He nods at the kobolds. "To them it was like the sun coming down. I taught them to plait wicks so the wax wouldn't drip, and now I'm king." He sighs. "It isn't so bad. Down here nobody asks me for accounts."

The negotiation

The group needs **three accepted arguments**: at least one must convince Odo and at least one Scratch. Each argument is a character's proposal followed by a check (DC 12; DC 10 at Favour 4–5; DC 14 at Favour 0–1). Each of the bookkeeper's clues the group holds counts automatically as one argument for Odo.

Argument	To whom	Check
"We have proof: with it, the mistress will believe you"	Odo	Persuasion (or automatic with each clue)
"If you stay, Wendel will try again, and down here they'll die with you"	Odo	Persuasion or Intimidation
Propose that the kobolds work in the mine in exchange for candles and cheese	Scratch	Persuasion; Advantage if Odo is already convinced
Promise that the Great Candle will come back every week to "light up" the shrine	Scratch	Persuasion or Deception
Challenge Scratch to hold a lit candle without it going out longer than he can	Scratch	Contested Constitution check
Give Scratch something that shines or burns brighter than Odo's crown	Scratch	No check if the gift is good

Outcome. With three arguments, Odo puts on the crown, blows it out in one breath and hands it to Scratch: "For the real king." Favour +1. With fewer than three, Odo still goes with the group when he hears the explosion, but Scratch doesn't forgive him, and the kobolds don't help in Scene 5 unless Favour is 4 or higher.

Missing clue. If the group didn't find the ledger in Scene 1, Odo keeps a page torn from Wendel's accounts: it is the player handout at the end of this book.

Favour at the end of the scene

0–2: the kobolds shut themselves in their burrows. Wick, if he is with the group, follows them anyway.

3: Scratch and two kobold miners join in Scene 5. They act at the end of the round.

4–5: as above, plus Soot, if she is still alive. Her Tremor can knock the thugs Prone.

Text: the king and the crown

Scratch walks slowly up to Odo, the candle on his helmet held very straight. He looks at the crown being offered to him. He looks at the kobolds, who are holding their breath. He looks at you.

"Great Candle go," he says at last, in his coughing voice. "But Great Candle come back. Every week. With cheese." He takes the crown in both hands and puts it on top of his helmet. It is far too big. It covers his eyes.

Nobody laughs. Scratch lifts it a little with one finger, to see, and for a moment he looks like the happiest kobold in the world.

Text: the explosion

The first explosion isn't heard: it's felt. All the candles on the ceiling tremble at once and a fine rain of wax and dust falls. The second one is heard, dull and distant, like an enormous door slamming shut.

Odo jumps to his feet.

"That's powder," he says. "In the new seam. That wretch is going to seal the exit... with all of us inside."

Scene 5: The Last Prop

> *"It's nothing personal. It's numbers."*
> — Wendel Scantcoin

The finale: Wendel and the Defias Brotherhood have come to take the last copper from the new seam and close the mine behind them. The group must stop them, save Odo and get out before the roof comes down.

Rule of the scene
Everything at once. Combat, checks and a clock that advances every round. The Game Master should make clear from the start which actions slow the clock.

1. **The arrival** (read "The new-seam gallery" and the text below). Wendel, Rufus Morral and two thugs (one for three characters; three for five) are loading copper onto a cart beside the smugglers' mouth. There are three powder charges with lit fuses on the props.
2. **The unmasking.** Wendel doesn't hide: there's no longer any need. If the group has proof and shows it to Rufus, see "Rufus and the accounts."
3. **Main encounter: the collapse.** Combat with the Collapse Clock running (mechanics below).
4. **Wendel's flight.** When he reaches half his Hit Points, Wendel runs for the smugglers' mouth. And there stands Stubborn, hooves planted, with Tilda behind her.
5. **The way out.** Everyone out, through the smugglers' mouth or however they can, before the sixth segment.

Text: the arrival

The new gallery is full of smoke and red light. By the exit stands a half-loaded cart of copper, and around it, three men with red kerchiefs at their necks. One, enormous, carries a mallet on his shoulder. On the props along the walls, three short fuses are sputtering.

In the middle, his book under his arm and his spectacles on the tip of his nose, stands Wendel. When he sees you, he sighs.

"I paid for your room," he says, disappointed. "I paid for it out of my own pocket."

Text: the unmasking

"Don't look at me like that." Wendel pushes up his spectacles. "Do you know what a bookkeeper earns in Elwynn? I do. I write it down every month. And every month it's too little. Mistress Callaver has a mine; I have a column of numbers that never adds up in my favour."

He looks at Odo, peering out from behind you with his face black with soot.

"You were supposed to be under a roof, Cardoso. It's nothing personal. It's numbers." He closes the book. "Rufus, if you please."

Collapse mechanics

- **Collapse Clock: 6 segments.** It advances 1 at the end of each round. The Game Master marks it where everyone can see: drawing six candles on paper and crossing one out each round works very well.
- **Slowing the clock.** Each of these actions removes 1 segment, once per round in total:

Action	Check
Pull the fuse from a charge (there are three)	Dexterity (Sleight of Hand) DC 12 or Thieves' Tools; each defused charge also removes 1 segment at the end
Shore up with a beam or a cart	Strength (Athletics) DC 13
Odo directs the shoring	No check, once per combat (see his stat block)
Soot holds up the rock with her magic	Only if she is with the group; once

- **Three segments.** Dust and stones fall. At the start of its turn, each creature in the gallery makes a Dexterity saving throw DC 10 or takes 2 (1d4) Bludgeoning damage.
- **Six segments.** The gallery collapses. Anyone still inside makes a Dexterity saving throw DC 12: on a failure, they are trapped under the rubble at 0 Hit Points but Stable; on a success, they roll out through the smugglers' mouth. Trapped characters are dug out afterwards by the kobolds if Favour is 2 or higher, or by Odo and Tilda if not. Nobody is crushed to death in this adventure.
- **Advantage from the clues.** If the group gathered all three of the bookkeeper's clues, the clock starts at 0 instead of 1: Odo knew what to look for and got there first.

Stubborn

When Wendel flees, he reaches the smugglers' mouth and finds the mule standing crosswise in the exit. Stubborn doesn't move. Wendel tries to get past, and the mule kicks him (+5, 7 (1d8 + 3) Bludgeoning damage), leaving him sitting in the mud. If the group helped Tilda overcome her fear, she is there, lantern raised, saying: "Nobody gets through here without paying." If not, the mule is alone, and Wendel falls just the same.

Difficulty adjustments

For three characters: a single thug and Wendel without his Powder Pouch. For five: three thugs. If the table is struggling, have Rufus waver early; if it's getting bored, have a charge go off in round 2 and jump the clock forward.

Text: Wendel's flight

> Wendel backs away with the book clutched to his chest, trips over a rail, gets up and runs for the crack by the stream, where the night sky shows through.
>
> And stops dead. In the exit, with all four hooves planted in the mud and her ears laid back, stands a mule. She looks at him. Wendel looks at her.
>
> "Move," says Wendel.
>
> Stubborn doesn't move.

Rufus and the accounts

If a character shows Rufus any proof of the double books (the ledger, Odo's page) and succeeds on a Persuasion check DC 13, Rufus does the sums aloud and discovers that Wendel has also kept his share. He lowers the mallet. He may leave or turn on Wendel, at the Game Master's choice, depending on the tone of the table. The thugs do whatever he does.

Epilogue

> *"Let the accounts show: the mine was saved by a mule, a kobold and some strangers. In that order."*
> — Hesperia Callaver

To be read at the end of the session, at the inn. Choose the variant of each paragraph according to what happened. The characters advance to 2nd level.

At dawn, Goldshire saw you coming up the south road: a foreman with a blackened face, a mule very pleased with herself and, carried or tied to the cart, a bookkeeper without his spectacles.

[If Wendel was captured] You handed him over to the Stormwind guard, who arrived, this time for real, in two days. With him went both ledgers. Only one of them added up. **[If he escaped]** Nobody saw Wendel in Elwynn again, but in Westfall there is talk of a bookkeeper with a red kerchief who keeps the accounts of someone very dangerous.

Mistress Callaver counted your coins twice, which is how she says thank you. Then she counted out fifteen more, which is how she says thank you and means it.

[Favour 3 or higher] A week later, the Copperseam reopened with a new crew: five miners, a foreman and eleven kobolds, who are paid in candles and cheese and haven't missed a single day. Scratch signs the contract with a thumbprint of wax. **[Favour 2 or lower]** The mine reopened, but nobody goes further down than the crossing. Below, in the dark, candles go on lighting up every night.

[If Wick went with the group] And Wick, the smallest lookout, came to live at the inn, where he steals sandwiches with permission and lights the candles on the miners' table, which is no longer empty.

Odo Cardoso kept his word. Every week he goes down to the shrine with a plaited candle and a cheese. He says it's for the kobolds. Hesperia knows it's because down there, for three days, he was king, and a man doesn't forget a thing like that.

Advancing to 2nd level

The characters advance to 2nd level at the end of the adventure, however many enemies they defeated. They went down into the mine as strangers and came back as neighbours: that is what counts.

Hooks for further play

- **The Defias Brotherhood.** The Copperseam's copper was heading for Westfall. Someone there is casting something very big.
- **The new seam.** It is far too rich for such a small mine. The kobolds say that further down "the stone sings."
- **Wendel.** If he escaped, he knows who ruined his business, and he is keeping count.
- **Mistress Callaver.** She owes the group a favour. And Hesperia Callaver always pays her debts.

Appendix A: Character Stat Blocks

> *"Candle no touch."*
> — Scene 2

The stat blocks follow the format of the 2024 edition of the rules (5.5). They are tuned for a group of three to five 1st-level characters. All values are provisional until the setting book is published.

Abbreviations. AC: Armor Class. HP: Hit Points. CR: Challenge Rating. XP: experience points. PB: Proficiency Bonus. DC: Difficulty Class. MOD: modifier. SAVE: saving throw.

Stat blocks by Challenge Rating

Character	CR	Scenes
Wendel Scantcoin	1	1, 5
Scratch, kobold chief	1/2	4, 5
Rufus Morral	1/2	5
Soot, kobold geomancer	1/4	3, 5
Odo Cardoso	1/4	4, 5
Kobold miner	1/8	2–5
Defias Brotherhood thug	1/8	5
Tilda Heath	0	1, 2, 5
Wick	0	2–5

The kobolds of the Copperseam

The kobolds of *Warcraft* are not little dragons but mining rodents, with snouts, tails and an absolute devotion to their candles. They attack in a pack, flee in a pack and come back in a pack.

Kobold Miner

Small Humanoid (kobold), Neutral

AC 12
Initiative +2 (12)
HP 5 (2d6 – 2)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	7	–2	–2	DEX	15	+2	+2	CON	9	–1	–1
INT	8	–1	–1	WIS	7	–2	–2	CHA	8	–1	–1

Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 8
Languages Common (haltingly), Kobold
CR 1/8 (XP 25; PB +2)

Traits

Pack Tactics. The kobold has Advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the kobold's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally doesn't have the Incapacitated condition.

You No Take Candle! If a creature snuffs or takes the kobold's candle, the kobold has Advantage on attack rolls against that creature until the end of the kobold's next turn.

Actions

Pick. *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) Piercing damage.

Sling. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +4, range 30/120 ft. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) Bludgeoning damage.

Soot, Kobold Geomancer

Small Humanoid (kobold), Neutral

AC 12
Initiative +2 (12)
HP 13 (3d6 + 3)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	8	–1	–1	DEX	14	+2	+2	CON	12	+1	+1
INT	10	+0	+0	WIS	14	+2	+4	CHA	9	–1	–1

Skills Perception +4, Survival +4
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 14
Languages Common (haltingly), Kobold
CR 1/4 (XP 50; PB +2)

Traits

Pack Tactics. Soot has Advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of Soot's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally doesn't have the Incapacitated condition.

Stone Hearing. Soot knows the location of every creature touching the ground within 30 feet of her, even if she can't see it.

Actions

Gravel Burst. *Ranged Spell Attack Roll:* +4, range 60 ft. *Hit:* 7 (2d4 + 2) Bludgeoning damage.

Tremor (1/Day). *Dexterity Saving Throw:* DC 12, each creature in a 10-foot Cube Soot can see within 60 feet. *Failure:* 5 (2d4) Bludgeoning damage, and the creature has the Prone condition. *Success:* Half damage.

Bonus Actions

Breath of the Candles (Recharge 5–6). Every candle within 30 feet of Soot goes out or lights up, as she chooses. An area without candles is plunged into Darkness.

Scratch, Kobold Chief

Small Humanoid (kobold), Lawful Neutral

AC 13 (leather breastplate and candle helmet)
Initiative +2 (12)
HP 22 (5d6 + 5)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	12	+1	+1	DEX	15	+2	+2	CON	12	+1	+1
INT	9	–1	–1	WIS	10	+0	+0	CHA	12	+1	+1

Skills Intimidation +3
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 10
Languages Common (haltingly), Kobold
CR 1/2 (XP 100; PB +2)

Traits

Pack Tactics. Scratch has Advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of Scratch's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally doesn't have the Incapacitated condition.

Crown of Wax. If the candle on his helmet goes out, Scratch has Disadvantage on attack rolls until he relights it, which takes a Bonus Action.

Actions

Multiattack. Scratch makes two *Big Pick* attacks.

Big Pick. *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) Piercing damage.

Bonus Actions

Big Candle Commands! One allied kobold within 30 feet that can hear him takes a Reaction to move up to half its Speed or make one attack.

Wick

Small Humanoid (kobold), Neutral Good

AC 13
Initiative +3 (13)
HP 3 (1d6)
Speed 30 ft., Climb 20 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	5	–3	–3	DEX	16	+3	+3	CON	10	+0	+0
INT	9	–1	–1	WIS	12	+1	+1	CHA	11	+0	+0

Skills Perception +3, Stealth +5
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 13
Languages Common (haltingly), Kobold
CR 0 (XP 10; PB +2)

Traits

Seam Sniffer. Wick has Advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks to find passages, cracks and metal.

Noncombatant. Wick never attacks unless someone touches his candle. In combat he hides and shouts advice.

Actions

Bite. *Melee Attack Roll:* +5, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 1 Piercing damage.

Bonus Actions

This Way! One ally within 30 feet that can hear him has Advantage on its next Survival or Investigation check inside the mine.

Wendel and the Defias Brotherhood

The rivals of Scene 5. None of them wants to die in a mine: they fight to get away, not to stay.

Defias Brotherhood Thug

Medium Humanoid (human), Neutral Evil

AC 12 (leather armor)
Initiative +1 (11)
HP 11 (2d8 + 2)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	12	+1	+1	DEX	12	+1	+1	CON	12	+1	+1
INT	10	+0	+0	WIS	10	+0	+0	CHA	10	+0	+0

Skills Athletics +3, Stealth +3
Senses Passive Perception 10
Languages Common
CR 1/8 (XP 25; PB +2)

Traits

Spurned Stonemason. The thug has Advantage on checks made to break or damage structures of stone or wood.

Actions

Scimitar. *Melee Attack Roll:* +3, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 + 1) Slashing damage.

Light Crossbow. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +3, range 80/320 ft. *Hit:* 5 (1d8 + 1) Piercing damage.

Rufus Morral

Medium Humanoid (human), Neutral

AC 11 (leather armor)
Initiative +0 (10)
HP 32 (5d8 + 10)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	15	+2	+2	DEX	11	+0	+0	CON	14	+2	+2
INT	10	+0	+0	WIS	10	+0	+0	CHA	11	+0	+0

Skills Athletics +4, Intimidation +2
Senses Passive Perception 10
Languages Common
CR 1/2 (XP 100; PB +2)

Traits

Spurned Stonemason. Rufus has Advantage on checks made to break or damage structures of stone or wood.

Rufus's Accounts. If shown that Wendel is cheating him, Rufus leaves the fight or turns on Wendel (see Scene 5).

Actions

Multiattack. Rufus makes two *Mason's Mallet* attacks.

Mason's Mallet. *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) Bludgeoning damage.

Wendel Scantcoin

Medium Humanoid (human), Neutral Evil

AC 12 (15 with *Mage Armor*)
Initiative +2 (12)
HP 27 (6d8)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	9	−1	−1	DEX	14	+2	+2	CON	10	+0	+0
INT	15	+2	+4	WIS	12	+1	+3	CHA	14	+2	+2

Skills Deception +6, Insight +3, Persuasion +4
Senses Passive Perception 11
Languages Common, Dwarvish, Gnomish
CR 1 (XP 200; PB +2)

Traits

Balanced Books. While he has half his Hit Points or fewer, Wendel spends his turns fleeing towards the smugglers' mouth.

Actions

Multiattack. Wendel makes two attacks, using *Hand Crossbow* or *Sharpened Quill* in any combination.

Hand Crossbow. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +4, range 30/120 ft. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) Piercing damage.

Sharpened Quill. *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) Piercing damage.

Powder Pouch (Recharge 6). *Dexterity Saving Throw:* DC 12, each creature in a 10-foot-radius Sphere centered on a point within 60 feet. *Failure:* 7 (2d6) Fire damage. *Success:* Half damage. If the Sphere touches a prop, the Collapse Clock advances 1.

Spellcasting. Wendel casts one of the following spells, using Intelligence as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 12):

At Will: Mage Hand, Prestidigitation
1/Day Each: Grease, Mage Armor

Bonus Actions

Bookkeeper's Retreat. Wendel takes the Disengage or Hide action.

Reactions

Human Shield. *Trigger:* An attack roll hits Wendel while one of his allies is within 5 feet of him. *Response:* The ally becomes the target of the attack instead.

Folk of Goldshire

Characters who shouldn't fight, but whose stat blocks may be needed if a scene goes sideways.

Odo Cardoso

Medium Humanoid (human), Lawful Good

AC 11 (sackcloth blanket with copper tokens)
Initiative +0 (10)
HP 19 (3d8 + 6)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	15	+2	+2	DEX	10	+0	+0	CON	15	+2	+4
INT	11	+0	+0	WIS	13	+1	+1	CHA	10	+0	+0

Skills Athletics +4, Perception +3, Survival +3
Senses Passive Perception 13
Languages Common, Kobold (about twenty words)
CR 1/4 (XP 50; PB +2)

Traits

Knows Every Prop. Odo has Advantage on checks to detect or avoid cave-ins. In Scene 5, once per combat and as an action, he slows the Collapse Clock by 1 segment without rolling.

The Great Candle. Kobolds that aren't hostile obey him when he speaks to them.

Actions

Foreman's Pick. *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) Piercing damage.

Tilda Heath

Medium Humanoid (human), Neutral Good

AC 10
Initiative +0 (10)
HP 6 (1d8 + 2)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	13	+1	+1	DEX	11	+0	+0	CON	14	+2	+2
INT	10	+0	+0	WIS	13	+1	+1	CHA	12	+1	+1

Skills Animal Handling +3, Perception +3, Survival +3
Senses Passive Perception 13
Languages Common
CR 0 (XP 10; PB +2)

Traits

Believes in Ghosts. Tilda has Disadvantage on saving throws against the Frightened condition.

Stubborn. While Tilda is within 30 feet of her, the mule does what Tilda asks. Almost always.

Actions

Lantern. *Melee Attack Roll:* +3, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 3 (1d4 + 1) Bludgeoning damage.

Stubborn, the mule

Use the Mule stat block from the SRD 5.2. Once, in Scene 5, she blocks Wendel's way and kicks him: +5, 7 (1d8 + 3) Bludgeoning damage.

Appendix B: Magic Items

> *"Plaited wick. No drips. That's the whole secret."*
> — Odo Cardoso

Items the characters can receive during the adventure, with the moment they are obtained. They are modest, as befits 1st level, and almost all of them have more story than power.

Plaited Kobold Candle

Wondrous Item, Common

Where it is found: Scene 3, in the dead-end gallery (1d6); or Scene 4, as a gift from Scratch.

A thick candle of yellowish wax with a plaited wick, in the style Odo taught the kobolds.

Patient Flame. It burns for 24 hours without shrinking or dripping and sheds Bright Light in a 10-foot radius. Ordinary wind doesn't put it out.

Safe Conduct. While you carry it lit, you have Advantage on Charisma checks made to deal with kobolds.

Foreman's Helmet

Wondrous Item, Common

Where it is found: Scene 5: Odo gives it to whoever did most to hold back the collapse.

A hardened-leather helmet with a brass holder for a candle, dented by twenty-two years of low ceilings.

Hands Free. A candle set in the helmet sheds light like a torch and doesn't go out if you fall Prone.

Creak. Once per day, you can give yourself Advantage on a Wisdom (Perception) check to detect a cave-in, a trap or an unstable ceiling.

Pick of the Great Candle

Weapon (War Pick), Uncommon

Where it is found: Scene 4: Odo leaves it in the shrine, and Scratch gives it to the group if Favour is 4 or higher.

Odo's pick, its haft covered in drops of coloured wax the kobolds stuck on it as offerings.

Stonebreaker. The weapon deals double damage to objects and structures of stone, and you have Advantage on Strength (Athletics) checks to dig or shore up.

Offering. Once per day, when you hit with it, you can make the wax flare: the target takes an extra 1d6 Fire damage.

Soot's Pebble

Wondrous Item, Common (consumable)

Where it is found: Scene 3: Soot hands it over if she surrenders or becomes an ally.

A grey pebble with a hole through the middle, like the ones Soot wears sewn to her cloak.

As a Magic action, you can smash it on the ground. *Dexterity Saving Throw:* DC 12, each creature other than you in a 10-foot Cube centered on you. *Failure:* the creature has the Prone condition. The pebble is used up.

Wendel's Double Ledger

Nonmagical item, evidence

Where it is found: Scene 5: taken from Wendel or dropped as he flees.

A leather-bound ledger with a second book hidden inside the cover. It balances, but only in Wendel's favour.

Irrefutable Proof. While you show it, you have Advantage on Charisma checks made to convince the Stormwind guard, Mistress Callaver or any member of the Defias Brotherhood that Wendel has robbed them.

Rufus's Red Kerchief

Nonmagical item, keepsake

Where it is found: Scene 5: Rufus drops it if he leaves the fight.

A worn red kerchief embroidered with initials that aren't Rufus's.

It may serve as a password in Westfall, for better or for worse. The Game Master decides which door it opens in a sequel.

Appendix C: To Be Adjusted with the Setting Book

This adventure was written before the setting book was published. Once it is available, the following points should be reviewed.

- ☐ Challenge Ratings and statistics for *Warcraft* kobolds (creature type, racial traits, relationship with candles).
- ☐ The provisional stat blocks in Appendix A, especially Wendel and Rufus Morral.
- ☐ If the book includes kobolds as a playable species, offer Wick as a character for a sequel.
- ☐ Rarity and properties of the items in Appendix B.
- ☐ Difficulty Classes for the runaway cart (Scene 3) and the Collapse Clock (Scene 5).
- ☐ Official names of places and factions in the book's English edition.
- ☐ Where the Defias Brotherhood sits in the timeline the book adopts.
- ☐ Currency equivalents and prices (Mistress Callaver's reward).

TO GIVE TO THE PLAYERS

Player Handout: The Torn Page

Scene 1 or Scene 4. Cut along the line or print separately.

Copperseam · Cartloads this month

copy for the mistress — and copy for me

Week	Declared to the mistress	Left the mine	"The kerchief lot"
First	4 cartloads	9	5 · 40 gp
Second	3 cartloads	8	5 · 40 gp
Third	3 cartloads	7	4 · 32 gp
Fourth	2 cartloads	7	5 · 40 gp
Total	**12**	**31**	**19 · 152 gp**

To Rufus, half of what he says. He can't count.
Cardoso asks too many questions. See to the crossing before Thursday.

— W. S.

Written in soot on the shrine wall:

THE LEDGER LAD
SAWED THE CROSSING.
I'M NOT COMING UP TILL THEY BELIEVE ME.

— O. C., foreman (and king, apparently)